GAMSA · Gender-Affirming Medicines South Australia

Blood test guide: Bicalutamide

Bicalutamide (not first-line) · gamsa.au/monitoring

Key points Liver tests, most of all in the first 6 months. A new cough or breathlessness needs checking at once.

Applies to me	Test	When	Aim	Talk to your prescriber if
☐	**Liver function**	Before starting, and regularly during treatment. It matters most in the first 6 months, when most liver changes happen	Within the lab's range	You have yellow skin or eyes, or dark urine: get checked straight away
☐	**Heart tracing (ECG) and electrolytes; INR**	ECG and electrolytes if you have a heart rhythm condition or take medicines that affect heart rhythm. INR checks if you take warfarin	—	You take warfarin, or start a medicine that affects heart rhythm
☐	**Breathing (lung inflammation)**	No routine test	—	You have a new cough, breathlessness or fever: tell your prescriber at once

A guide to what to expect, not a schedule to follow on your own. Your prescriber sets the timing.

Reading your results

- A single flagged result is a reason to talk with your prescriber, not to change a dose on your own.

Sources: AusPATH 2026 p28; Cosudex PI s4.4, s4.5. Full references and detail for clinicians: gamsa.au/monitoring.

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